

NOT QUITE COMPLETE

India clinched the Asia Cup, played in the T20 format, for a record-extending ninth time, though the triumph was overshadowed by political tensions with Pakistan.

Led by Suryakumar Yadav, India defeated Pakistan by seven wickets in the group stage but declined the customary post-match handshake. The side went on to remain unbeaten in the league phase before adding three more victories in the Super Fours.

India opened the Super Fours with another win over Pakistan, again maintaining its no-handshake stance, before beating Bangladesh and edging past Sri Lanka in a Super Over thriller to reach the final.

The title clash once more pitted the arch-rivals against each other. Pakistan began strongly but suffered a dramatic collapse, slipping from 107 for one to be bowled out for 147. India's chase was steadied by Tilak Varma, whose unbeaten 69 guided

his side home despite an early wobble that saw three wickets fall for 20 runs.

Controversy followed the win. In response to India's refusal to shake hands and accept the trophy from PCB chairman Mohsin Naqvi, the champion team was not presented with the winner's trophy at the ceremony.

The presentation was delayed by over an hour as Pakistani players remained in their dressing room, eventually ending with India staging improvised celebrations, holding aloft a symbolic, make-believe trophy.



REBUILD COMPLETE

The Oklahoma City Thunder ended a long wait for an NBA title, its first since relocating from Seattle in 2008 and only its second overall after the 1979 championship as the SuperSonics.

It had come close in 2012, when Kevin Durant, Russell Westbrook and James Harden led OKC to the Finals, only to fall to LeBron James' Miami Heat. More than a decade of rebuilding followed before the pieces finally aligned under head coach Mark Daigneault.

This time, the new core finished the job. Shai Gilgeous-Alexander, Chet Holmgren and Jalen Williams powered the Thunder past the Indiana Pacers in a seven-game Finals series to claim the crown.

OKC dominated all season, winning 68 games in the regular season before asserting itself in the playoffs. It swept the Memphis Grizzlies, eliminated defending champion Denver Nuggets, and dispatched the Minnesota Timberwolves 4-1 in the Western Conference Finals.

Indiana stretched the Finals to a decider, but the absence of injured star Tyrese Haliburton proved decisive in Game 7. Gilgeous-Alexander capped a historic campaign by becoming the first player in 25 years to win the regular-season MVP, scoring title and Finals MVP in the same season.

With Holmgren and Williams alongside him, he delivered the Thunder's long-awaited title and signalled the start of a potentially defining era.

